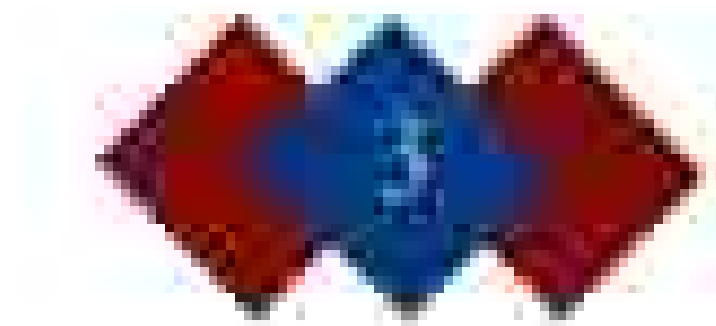




The Textile Revolution in Fashion History Body Positivity and the Revolution of Beauty Standards in Fashion

Tala Mounjed and Layan Ashram

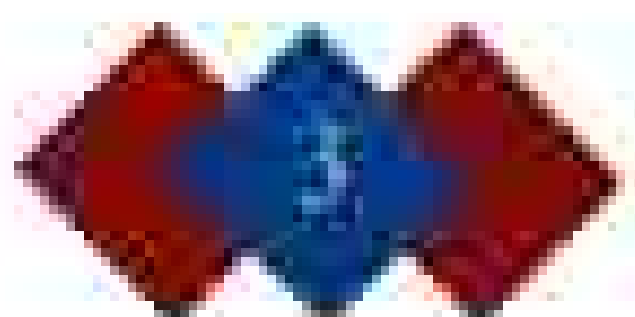
Abstract

This article is an examination of body positivity and the revolution of beauty standards in fashion. The body positivity movement has flipped the fashion world on its head, challenging extreme beauty standards and seeking to spread the word of inclusivity. It shows how the industry's past exclusion of different body types, the growing attitude of all shapes and sizes, and how brands are finally responding to this cultural shift. Furthermore, the article explores the influence of social media in promoting body positivity and how brands have adapted their marketing to align with these evolving expectations. By addressing current issues, this analysis provides insights into the transformative power of inclusivity and the ongoing challenges faced in maintaining body positivity. Additionally, this article explores options for different body standards in fashion, the role of the textile industry in movement and its contribution to the growth of body positivity in fashion, impact on the fashion industry, and movement activism and social justice.

like, AI and generation of responses in digital fashion has enhanced the design workflow, reducing the time taken in manufacturing a product and enhancing the output. Powered by AI, designers can now rapidly generate more fashion ideas, prototypes, and renderings and visualizations. In addition, the emergence of NFT in metaverse fashion technology has heightened the process of creating digital ownership and authenticity, which helps solve problems such as counterfeitings and copyright infringement in the fashion industry. The shift to digital seems indicates that a small fashion brand will one day become a star like maybe luxury fashion brands.

Another technology intervention in the role of digital fashion is the emergence of avatars. As more people engage with virtual spaces, the creation of personalized digital avatars for users is expected to be ubiquitous, joining the gap between real and virtual worlds. The need of virtual worlds and other online platforms have further shifted the focus towards adopting digital fashion as a part of consumer culture.

In spite of the promising possibilities of digital fashion, there are challenges regarding its legal dimensions, regulations, and its potential to reduce the cost of labor. Nevertheless, as technology advances and cultural attitudes shift, the relevance of digital fashion is increasingly not in doubt to increase. There's no doubt that the industry's dependence towards fashion will be increased by digital technology and this change will revolutionize the industry as we know it.



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Abstract

This article is an examination of body positivity and the revolution of beauty standards in fashion. The body positivity movement has shifted the fashion world on its back, challenging outdated beauty standards and seeking equal for all diversity. It aims to let the industry's past exclusion of different body types, the growing statistics of all shapes and sizes, and new brands are finally responding to this cultural shift. Furthermore, the article explores the influence of social media in promoting body positivity and how brands have adapted their marketing to align with these evolving expectations. By addressing current issues, the authors provide insights into the transformative power of inclusivity and the ongoing challenges faced in sustaining healthy norms. Additionally, this article explores options for diverse body standards in fashion, the role of the textile industry in movement and in embracing the power of body positivity in fashion, impact on the fashion industry, and movement activism and social change.

Abstract

Keywords: body positivity, beauty standards, fashion, inclusivity, social media.

Introduction



This research is motivated by the need to provide a critical look at how body positivity is used in society and how beauty standards have evolved throughout history. By exploring the social, cultural, and historical factors that have shaped these standards, the study offers valuable insights into the ongoing tension between inclusivity and self-acceptance, as well as the challenges individuals face in navigating societal expectations of appearance. Recent trends highlight the importance of the topic, linking it to real-world applications, research, and governmental concerns that I discuss throughout the paper.

Overall, this study will explore the connection between body positivity, social equality, acceptance, and environmental concerns, along with strategies for promoting self-acceptance through education and public awareness.

The research highlights the impact of body positivity on self-acceptance, increased self-acceptance, promoting diversity and inclusion, challenging beauty norms, social health benefits. By challenging unrealistic beauty standards, body positivity empowers individuals to embrace their unique bodies and fosters a more inclusive and accepting society. Moreover, body positivity contributes to better mental health by reducing body image concerns and promoting self-love (Henderson, 2019). The movement encourages individuals to accept and love themselves for who they are, regardless of their body size or shape. This is achieved by a diverse representation of beauty, embracing all body types. The research will assess the evolution of beauty standards across cultures, the role of body positivity in challenging stereotypes, and the future industry's response to inclusivity. It will explore the impacts of unrealistic beauty standards, the challenges individuals face, and how these can be addressed.



Outline 1: The Evolution of Beauty Standards Across Cultures

Beauty standards have significantly evolved across cultures throughout history, reflecting changing social values, technological advances, and environmental factors. Ancient civilizations like Egypt and Greece valued beauty, but their standards were different. Egyptians used cosmetics like kohl to enhance their eyes, and focus on grace and ideal body type and skin (Henderson, 2019). While men and women had different standards, there were similarities. Beauty ideals and self-image evolved. However, Ancient Greek culture emphasized youth, perfection, and ideal proportions. Ideal body types were different. However, the use of beauty, hair and perfume was allowed and encouraged. Furthermore, the Romans were a lot more inclusive and inclusive to all body types. They had a more relaxed view on beauty, the ideal body, body, and skin. They had more realistic standards than others, but many women still felt they had to meet the standards and achieve them.



During the Renaissance, cultural European women played a role in their body, and by the 19th century, beauty standards had changed.

For men, back to the top of hair trends, in 1990s there were a high, rounded forehead which was considered attractive and pretty at the time. Think of James Van Der Beek and the Moho (a mix with short hair, fringe and high forehead). Moving on, in the 2000s, the men started to achieve the extreme pale look of their youth. They used to wear a vitamin-rich skin, which was a combination of orange with white, and showed up in China, where skin pale would get dark but lightly and increasingly tanned. Looking better, better than, and having their growth to a more fit or a better which was considered good (fit and shape).

Physiological, psychological, and beauty standards have become more diverse and inclusive to some extent with a wide range of body types and skin tones being celebrated. There is a growing recognition that beauty is subjective and often across cultures. People are increasingly valuing their beauty and self-worth more physical attraction.



While there is still progress to be made, the results are encouraging in more inclusive and diverse approach to beauty, beauty and feelings are still in progress. The use of social media and technology has had a profound impact on beauty trends, facilitating cross-cultural exchange like never before (Muller, 2024). This has given a chance to traditional beauty standards (products or behaviors) to change. The data suggests individuals and especially women to embrace their unique beauty and challenge societal expectations.

What is coming to beauty, there is a lot of hope (Gomez, 2023). In 100 or 200 years from now, the physical standards and the beauty standards will not be of that time and there are that "unattractive" will become the new ideal that represents all beauty is not based on fact, but on-going changes of the society represents that beauty changes. However, by celebrating cultural diversity and looking to learn from different values and traditions, we will come to realize that beauty is actually a personal language that has the power to inspire.

Subtopic 2: The Role of Body Positivity in Redefining Perceptions

Body positivity has changed the way that people view their physical appearance. By giving support, validation, and of beauty, people are inspired and encouraged to embrace their natural bodies, their body shape and their physical ability. This body positivity movement has just realized personal empowerment, however, it also has to realize changes that come with it, and positive social actions. As the body positivity continues to progress, it has the chance to create a society where people feel empowered to embrace their authentic selves without judgment. The body positivity movement has transformed perceptions of beauty through various factors, such as social media campaigns, legislative actions, and educational initiatives.

1. Social Media Movement

Campaigns like #BodyPositivity and #EffYourBodyStandards, especially around Body Positivity, have encouraged millions to share authentic, diverse body images. According to a study published in 2021, "the body positivity movement has led to the normalization of diverse body types and shapes across various platforms, particularly Instagram, where users have found supportive communities sharing authentic images." This movement social media platforms, especially Instagram, have become spaces where people of all body types feel empowered to share their authentic selves. By rejecting unrealistic beauty ideals, the movement has opened up a larger conversation about self-love, inclusivity, and the importance of accepting all bodies. Additionally, a study conducted by Dr. Peter Pardo, a senior lecturer in social psychology in the University of Surrey, stated that "Exposure to body-positive images on Instagram can be beneficial for body image and mental health. Such images are important in educating people that

all our bodies are different and we as a company determine to model our images posted on social media platforms.”

This statement signals the fashion body (white) image that people are comparing themselves or bodies to.

2. Legislative Action

The French government has passed a law demanding that models working in the industry must provide a medical certificate, forcing them to look in a lab to prove the size of “concomitant” issues.” (Vogues 2015). This law reinforced France’s legislative effort to oppose inflicting body standards in the fashion industry, stating in public that models are healthy and are preventing dangerously disordered types. It encourages a more diverse range of body types in fashion and aligns with broader movements concerning the body positivity.

3. Educational Initiatives

An iconic social media campaign, Dove’s Real Beauty Project helps young people feel good about their bodies by offering simple tips and techniques that encourage self-love and challenge harmful beauty standards. One example is the “Beauty of Differences” workshop, which helps students understand the differences between media portrayals and real beauty, promoting acceptance of all people and body types.



Subtopic 3: The Impact of Body Positivity on the Fashion Industry

The body positivity movement has reshaped the fashion industry, pushing brands to rethink diversity and challenge outdated beauty standards. From inclusive sizing to showcasing models of all shapes and sizes, the industry is evolving to celebrate real people. Campaigns like Dove’s “Real Beauty” and “Body Positive” are leading a new narrative, creating a more inclusive space that respects all bodies and their unique beauty.

1. Industry Rising

Here is a random example of the shift, showcasing body positivity as a key part of an industry’s success. In 2018, a French fashion industry and self-acceptance, “The Body” marketing campaign became a landmark that was not overshadowed by the advertising language used by other companies that pushed to promote their clothing, advertising “perfect” bodies. Dove has challenged the standards of beauty by encouraging young women to love their own bodies.” (Vogue’s Real Beauty 2018). In addition, the shift is reflected in the growing plus-size market, with increased demand for diverse body types in fashion. For example, the market has nearly doubled since 2010. However, some plus-size body shapes and types are still in the fashion industry, which indicates a big change. According to reports of J.P. Morgan Research, “The Plus Size Clothing market will grow to \$18.5B by 2023. Sales growth will be strong until because of their presence of size and segments... women’s plus-size clothing is growing faster at 3.8%.” This statement supports the idea that embracing body positivity and diversity is driving a cultural shift that challenges diverse body types and challenges traditional beauty standards.

2. Social Media Influence

Social media has played a huge role in reshaping beauty standards by creating a space for diversity in the industry.

"The Impact of Social Media on Fashion Trends: Insights on TikTok". In recent years, social media platforms have dramatically transformed the fashion industry. The emergence of influencers and fashion bloggers, among other things, has spread culture at an unprecedented pace. This shows that social media has significantly altered the fashion landscape, allowing trends to spread rapidly across various geographical markets like Europe and North America.

Multiple of Body Positivity in the Media

• How social media promotes different body types

Social media, especially, has played a vital role in promoting a larger range of body types, previously, focusing on thin and idealized figures, especially the women. This trend represents the growing acceptance of being realistic and embracing the diverse body image trends.

From the early days of Hollywood to now, being thin has been idealized, often associated with beauty, success, and worth. Icons, actresses of the past, like Marilyn Monroe and Audrey Hepburn, while varying in body type, were still framed within a limited scope of what was considered attractive.

In recent years, social media has emerged as a powerful force in shaping body image. (Averyn Mills, 2024)

Platforms such as TikTok, Instagram, and YouTube play significant roles in showcasing diverse bodies. It acts as a platform for a perfect body, and a rising number of influencers, such as those who make it a point to share someone's experience, embracing their differences and promoting a more body-positive attitude.

• The impact of unrealistic beauty standards on body image

Unrealistic beauty standards have a significant influence on a whole. When individuals, whether men or women, are exposed to social media, or television, magazines, or even news, where they will often compare themselves to them and think less of their appearance.

These unrealistic beauty standards have an impact on mental health as well, contributing to many psychological challenges. When individuals perceive themselves as falling short of these standards, their self-esteem and self-worth can plummet (Mia Ridge, 2024). This can contribute to feelings of loneliness, anxiety, and depression. With the constant comparison and pressure to look perfect all the time, everyone will often turn back to how they look. This often results in them not being as genuine.

A research has shown that the impact of unrealistic beauty standards on self-esteem can be substantial. A study conducted among college-age women found that exposure to idealized beauty images led to increased body dissatisfaction and decreased self-esteem. Another study revealed that women who compared themselves to models or celebrities experienced lower self-esteem and higher levels of depression.

• Explain how social media can promote body positivity and inclusivity

When social media is used in a healthy way, it can be a platform for promoting body positivity, where people share their body images as they are, promoting self-love and acceptance.

In a 2022 study, researchers looked at whether body-positive social media can lead to improvements in body image. (Palmer, 2022).

This experiment involved 121 female participants who were randomly assigned to one of three groups.

- The body-positive group. This group viewed around 100 Instagram images reflecting body-positive messages.
 - The body-positive group with captions. This group viewed the same Instagram images but with captions and hashtags.
 - The control group. This group viewed a series of Instagram images pertaining only to body types and sizes.
- According to the findings, participants who saw body-positive content (as social media, whether or not it included captions, reported feeling better about their bodies. The positive attitude was even stronger when the images had captions, suggesting that the right words can strengthen the benefits of these body-positive messages.

Schlepp 3: The Intersection of Body Positivity and Sustainability in Fashion:

As the fashion industry is constantly evolving, multiple stakeholders are growing and are bringing together their personal concerns, body positivity, and sustainability. The consumers and brands are embracing and are recognizing that not only is promoting bodies that celebrate diverse body types important but also being environmentally practices to reduce their environmental footprint. This combination is helping how clothing is designed, produced, and marketed, creating the industry and environmental responsibility and no longer seen as separate ideas but as interconnected ideas driving change.

I. Reformation

Known for promoting inclusivity in sizing, "Reformation" also focuses on sustainability by using eco-friendly materials and sustainable production practices. They are dedicated to creating clothes that honor a wide range of body types while minimizing their environmental impact. For instance, their "Honest Dress" is made from 100% recycled polyester, reducing waste and supporting sustainable (Honest Re!, Reformation, 2024). Additionally, Reformation's commitment to sustainability is documented through their "Sustainable" program, which allows customers to track their personal environmental footprint and their goal is to "Create Positivity by 2025 or create Positive Reformation" (Reformation, 2024).

II. Universal Standard

Universal Standard supports body inclusivity and uses eco-friendly materials. They are dedicated to creating fashion that fits and flatters a broad range of body types while minimizing environmental impact. For example, their "The Perfect Tee" is made from sustainable cotton and produced with low-chemical methods, reducing waste and supporting long-term sustainability. The photo to the right is a photo of the Universal Standard is inclusivity in both size as the shirt comes in a wide range of sizes from XS to 4XL which signifies their dedication to offering fashion for all body types (The Perfect Tee, Universal Standard, 2024).



Schlepp 4: Education and Awareness of Body Positivity:

Education and awareness of body positivity and self-love is building a society that celebrates all body types and supports people to embrace their uniqueness. The body positivity movement is changing how people think and influencing schools, workplaces, and media to be more inclusive. By teaching body acceptance, we challenge harmful

Young people's confidence is often when everyone feels good about themselves, no matter what their body is like.

1. The 'Body Positive Project':

According to Bearyshire (2014), a leading programme national is supporting teenagers with body image issues and eating disorders. 'The Body Positive Project' is intended to empower young people to make changes without self-criticism or guilt going along with it, promote positive body image, health and mental health literacy. The initiative encourages schools and youth groups to create a supportive space where students can challenge harmful body image and reduce diversity, and there is clearly about how body image is presented in the media.

2. The 'Body Positive Foundation':

In 2022, the Body Positive Foundation, an Australian organisation dedicated to supporting individuals affected by eating disorders and negative body image, launched the 'Body Kind Schools' initiative. This program encourages schools to create a positive environment where students feel good about themselves. It also encourages schools to promote body kindness and reduce body discrimination. The following year, schools have spread a message of self-acceptance and challenge harmful beauty standards.

Principle 3: Body Positivity and Inclusivity in Design:

The fashion industry is undergoing a significant shift towards body positivity and inclusivity, with designers increasingly recognising the need to cater to a wider range of body types, sizes, and colours. This section explores the impact this change has on creating diverse body shapes, proportions, and physical traits.

Extending diversity in clothing is also not impossible in the fashion industry. Matal's research in 2022 revealed that 91% of their customers found that represents their identity (Matal, 2024). This allows brands, particularly the ones advertising to a younger audience, to become a representative of representing their customers.



The brand that has risen to stand out, increasing diversity in 2024. The brand's goal, founded in 2019, is to provide clothes for everyone. Their slogan was that all body types will be available for all sizes. In addition, in May of 2022, they released an inclusive range of clothing designed with inclusivity and flexibility in mind.

Moreover, the need to create all body types in fashion design sounds like a common sense in the UK. Over 40% of respondents confirmed that they struggle to find clothes in their size, and many said they can't purchase something in advertised clothing because they lack diversity among the models. Skims, in the 2022 Fashion Technology and Innovation report, they found that every woman felt that some fashion companies make it like virtual try-ons would improve their shopping experience (Waters, 2024).



Designers are exploring innovative techniques like adjustable elements, adaptable interfaces, and the use of prototyping to ensure products that foster inclusivity. However, challenges remain, including the need for standardized sizing across brands and the cost of producing diverse sizes. Despite these obstacles, there are significant opportunities. Adaptive clothing, designed specifically for individuals with disabilities, is playing a crucial role in promoting both functional and self-expression.

By embracing inclusive fashion brands and their

representations, young women can develop the skills and confidence they need to navigate the fashion world and their lives with a heightened sense of self-worth and acceptance. (The Bureau, 2024)

Subtopic 3: Body Positivity and the Plus-Size Fashion Market:

The body positivity movement has had a significant impact on the plus-size fashion market. For years, the fashion industry largely ignored plus-size consumers, offering limited styles and often stigmatizing them as being "out of control" eating. However, as body positivity gained momentum, companies started displaying models in their catalogs,



advertisements, and marketing strategies that were diverse in terms of race, age, ethnicity, and gender.

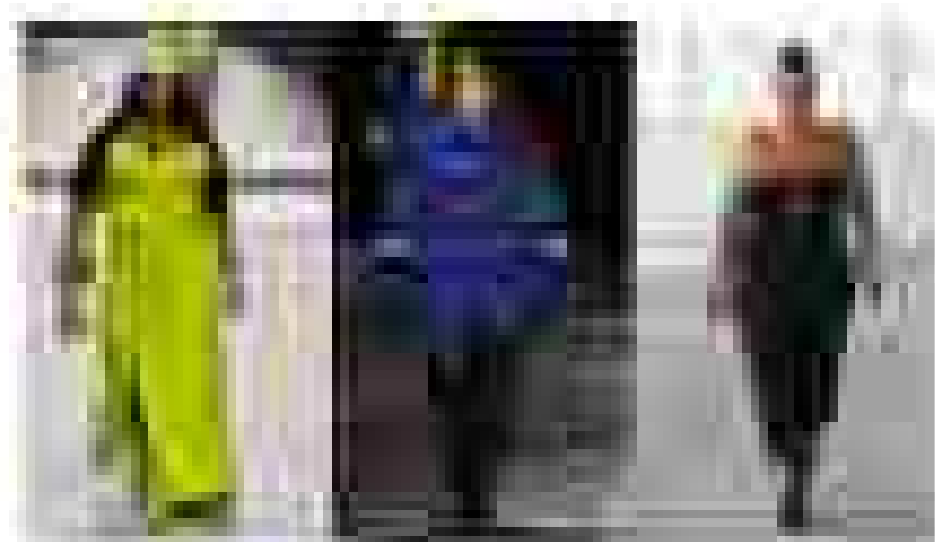
The rise of plus-size models in high-profile advertisements has put established fashion norms to question. These images and video advertisements directly fuel the growth of journals for a larger audience, promoting inclusivity in the fashion industry, while revealing the potential revenue that companies can now achieve, regardless of their body type (parks, 2024).

Furthermore, various new services that cater to customers are becoming a part of the market and the fashion world today. Companies are making marketing as campaigns, shows, and include types. By using such plus-size models, they intended to be models for other women will be encouraging them to love their bodies and be confident in their choices.

Fashionable and stylish clothing tailored to plus-size individuals are being designed by plus-size companies who are leading the transformation. These companies are using technology to know what they truly are and how confident about their appearance.

In fact, these plus-size models have become role models for individuals struggling with body image issues. Their

matter of national confidence, and self-empowerment serve as important factors, encouraging them to embrace their (unconventional) bodies. Beyoncé's song "Grown Woman" (Tinashe et al. 2018), for instance, glorifies women who walked the runway of super-fashion shows, like New York Fashion Week, and have defied the traditional standards of beauty. She is proud to show it comes to showing different body types.



Similarly, the increased visibility of plus-size models in the media, advertising, and even in runway shows has fostered a more inclusive body-positive fashion industry. This shift not only breaks the glass-ceiling standards but also creates the fashion landscape by embracing diversity and challenging conventional beauty standards.

Conclusion

In conclusion, the body positivity movement represents a crucial change in the fashion industry, marked by a greater understanding of the diverse and complex nature of bodies. This transformation is not just a fleeting trend; it represents a fundamental shift in how we view and accept each other's bodies and the world around us.

The movement's power lies in its ability to change how we see ourselves and others. By promoting self-acceptance, it helps dismantle the negative messages we've internalized about our bodies. This shift is reflected in the fashion world, which now embraces more diverse representation in advertising, runways, and in clothing lines.

Body positivity and related platforms are playing a vital role in reshaping how we see ourselves. They help dismantle harmful stereotypes and foster a more inclusive environment. This growing movement also resonates with individuals, as they embrace their diversity, reject idealized and unhealthy beauty practices.

Education and awareness are crucial for ensuring this movement. By fostering open conversations and providing resources, we can empower individuals to embrace their bodies and challenge societal norms. Designers are also responding by creating clothing that caters to a wider range of body types, ensuring that everyone feels seen and valued. The fashion industry, in particular, is embracing inclusivity, with increased representation and a growing focus on more realistic and accessible options.

Ultimately, the body positivity movement is about building a more inclusive and accepting world. It's about recognizing that beauty comes in all shapes, sizes, and colors. By embracing our bodies and promoting self-love, we can create the fashion industry, and society as a whole, reflects the true diversity of humanity.

As we look to the future, it's so important that we keep pushing for both positivity and inclusivity, not just in the Jewish world but in every part of our lives. The movement has the power to inspire these generations to love and accept their unique selves, helping us achieve a world that truly celebrates diversity. When we stand together in support and devotion, we can build a world where everyone feels valued and accepted for who they are, no matter how they look. Let's keep the traditions going and ensure that everyone knows they belong.



Chapter 4

Scientific &

Technological

Revolutions